The steam thus produced is used to rotate the turbine. As a result, electricity is produced. Atomic power stations are also called as nuclear power stations. Here nuclear energy is converted into mechanical energy and then electrical energy.

4. Wind mills



In wind mills, wind energy is used to rotate the turbine to produce electricity. Here kinetic energy is converted into electrical energy.

2.2 Cell

A device that converts chemical energy into electrical energy is called a cell.

A chemical solution which produces positive and negative ions is used as electrolyte. Two different metal plates are inserted into electrolyte as electrodes to form a cell. Due to chemical reactions, one electrode gets positive charge and the other gets negative charge producing a continuous flow of electric current.

Depending on the continuity of flow of electric current cells are classified in to two types. They are primary cells and secondary cells.

Primary Cells

They can not be recharged. So they can be used only once. Hence, the primary cells are usually produced in small sizes.

Examples

cells used in clocks, watches and toys etc., are primary cells.



Secondary Cells

A cell that can be recharged many times is called secondary cell. These cells can be recharged by passing electric current. So they can be used again and again. The size of the secondary cells can be small or even large depending upon the usage. While the secondary cells used in mobiles are in the size of a hand, the cells used in automobiles like cars and buses are large and very heavy.





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